CPI Preview: Hot Headline, Tame Core, And An October Hike Nobody Wants

CPI 前瞻：整体 CPI 火热，核心 CPI 温和，以及无人希望看到的 10 月加息

BY TYLER DURDEN

WEDNESDAY, OCT 14, 2026 - 11:48 AM

A month ago the Fed's next move hinged on the second decimal of core CPI. This time the bar is far lower, or at least the Fed is pretending it is.

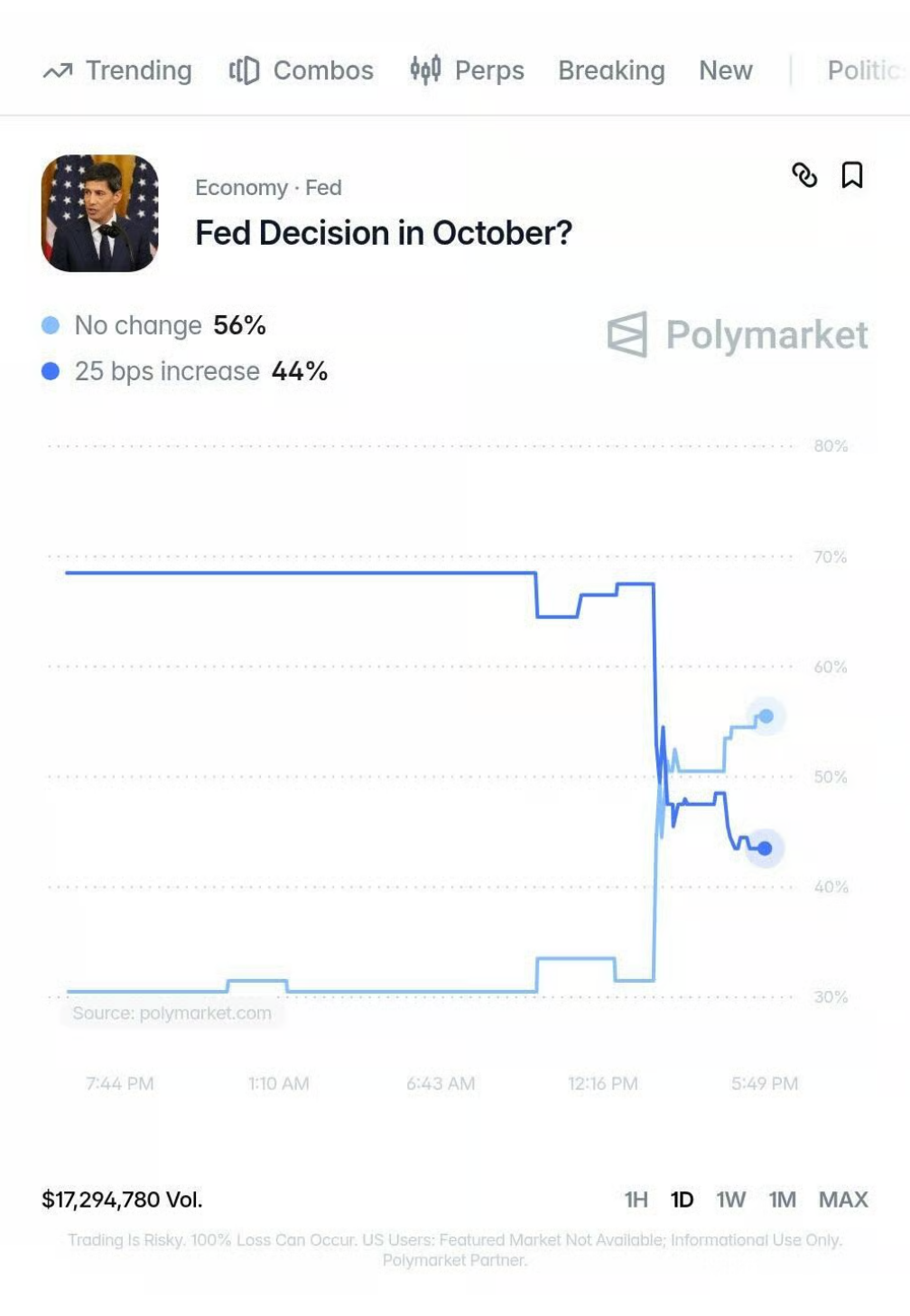
一个月前，美联储的下一步行动取决于核心 CPI 小数点后第二位的数值。这一次，门槛低得多——至少美联储是这么装作的。

Recall that in September the FOMC hiked rates for the first time since July 2023, just days after an August CPI report that showed the lowest core inflation since 2021 (which however sent rate-hike odds soaring as it came in just fractionally above the median estimate). Last week's FOMC minutes showed all 19 officials backed that hike and that "most" see another one by year-end as appropriate. But then the September payrolls report came in at a dismal 29K, wage growth slowed to 3.0% (the weakest since May 2021), and the Fed's heavy hitters suddenly discovered the virtue of patience: Jefferson and Williams say there is time to assess the data, Waller wants more hikes but **not at consecutive meetings**, and Bowman sees no urgency at all. Williams added on Tuesday that one more hike this year is "likely" appropriate, with nothing further in 2027.

回想一下，9 月，美联储联邦公开市场委员会（FOMC）自 2023 年 7 月以来首次加息。就在几天前公布的 8 月 CPI 报告显示，核心通胀率降至 2021 年以来最低水平（不过，由于数据仅略高于市场预估中值，加息概率随之大幅飙升）。上周公布的 FOMC 会议纪要显示，19 位官员全都支持此次加息，而且“多数”官员认为年底前再加息一次是合适的。但随后，9 月非农就业报告表现惨淡，新增就业仅为 2.9 万；薪资增速放缓至 3.0%（为 2021 年 5 月以来最低）。美联储几位重量级官员突然开始强调耐心的价值：杰斐逊和威廉姆斯表示，可以留出时间评估数据；沃勒希望进一步加息，但不希望连续数次会议都加息；鲍曼则认为完全没有紧迫性。威廉姆斯周二补充称，今年再加息一次“可能”是合适的，而 2027 年则不需要进一步加息。

The result: **market-implied odds of a 25bp October hike have collapsed to ~20% from ~70% before the jobs report**, while December is still roughly 72% priced. The reversal started even before payrolls, when Williams said there was no "urgency" to act and October hike odds on Polymarket tumbled from 68% to 44% in a few hours:

结果是：市场隐含的 10 月加息 25 个基点概率已从就业报告公布前的~70%骤降至~20%，而市场仍将 12 月加息的概率定价在约 72%。这一逆转甚至在非农就业数据公布前就已开始：威廉姆斯表示没有“紧迫性”采取行动后，Polymarket 上的 10 月加息概率在几小时内从 68%跌至 44%：



Which brings us to Wednesday's September CPI (8:30am ET), which **will set the tone for both the Oct 28 and the December meetings**. Thursday brings PPI (headline seen +0.5% M/M, core +0.3%), which analysts will use to refine their September core PCE estimates, and early Friday Chair Warsh speaks at the IMF in Bangkok, where traders will look for any hint of whether he shares his colleagues' newfound patience. Warsh dislikes forward guidance, of course, which just means everyone will read his tea leaves even harder.

这就引出了周三公布的 9 月 CPI（美东时间上午 8:30），其结果将为 10 月 28 日和 12 月的议息会议定下基调。周四将公布 PPI（整体 PPI 预期环比上涨 0.5%，核心 PPI 上涨 0.3%），分析师将据此完善对 9 月核心 PCE 的估算。周五一早，沃什主席将在曼谷出席国际货币基金组织活动并发表讲话，交易员将留意他是否认同同事们近期展现出的耐心。沃什当然不喜欢前瞻指引，这只会让所有人更加仔细地揣摩他的言外之意。

Expectations

- **Headline CPI** is expected to rise 0.6% M/M in September (prev. 0.4%), lifting the annual rate to **3.6% Y/Y** (prev. 3.4%) as gasoline does the heavy lifting.

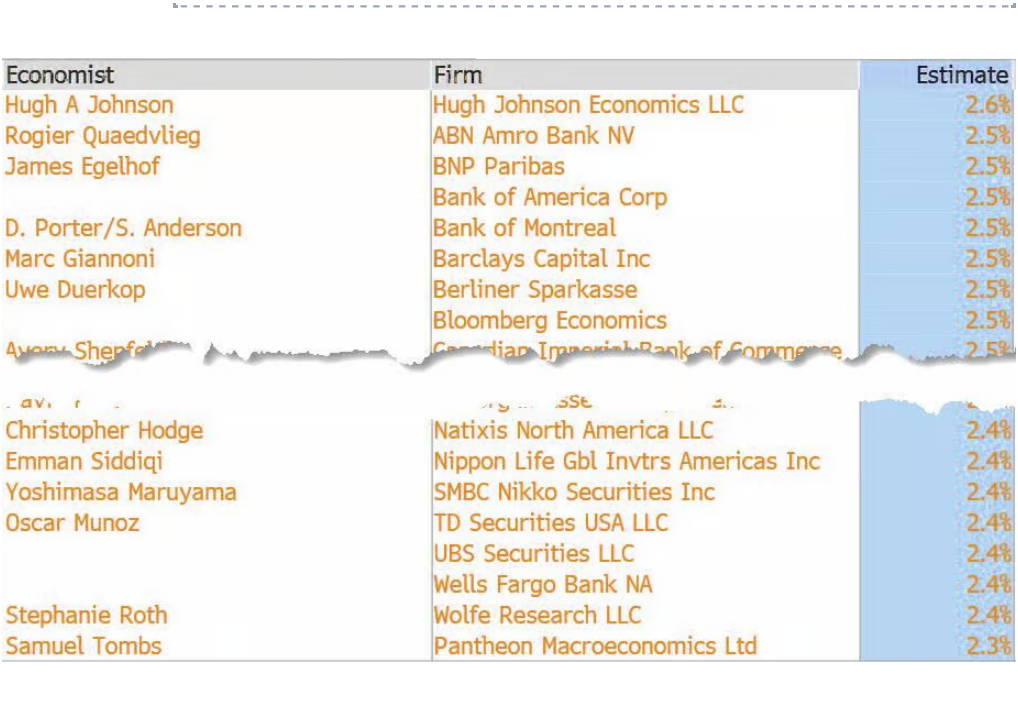
  预计 9 月整体 CPI 环比上涨 0.6%（前值为 0.4%），推动同比涨幅升至 3.6%（前值为 3.4%），汽油价格将是主要推手。

- **Core CPI** is expected to rise 0.2% M/M (prev. 0.3%), moderating from August's reading, which was the fastest monthly pace in four months. The annual core rate is seen edging up to **2.5% Y/Y** (prev. 2.4%), with analyst estimates raning from 2.6% for Hugh Johnson Economics to 2.3% for Pantheon Macro.

  预计核心 CPI 环比上涨 0.2%（前值为 0.3%），较 8 月有所放缓；8 月数据是四个月来最快的月度涨幅。核心 CPI 同比涨幅预计小幅升至 2.5%（前值为 2.4%），分析师预估区间为 Hugh Johnson Economics 的 2.6%至 Pantheon Macro 的 2.3%。

  - Goldman is on the firm side of consensus for core: 0.24% M/M vs a consensus mean of 0.22%.

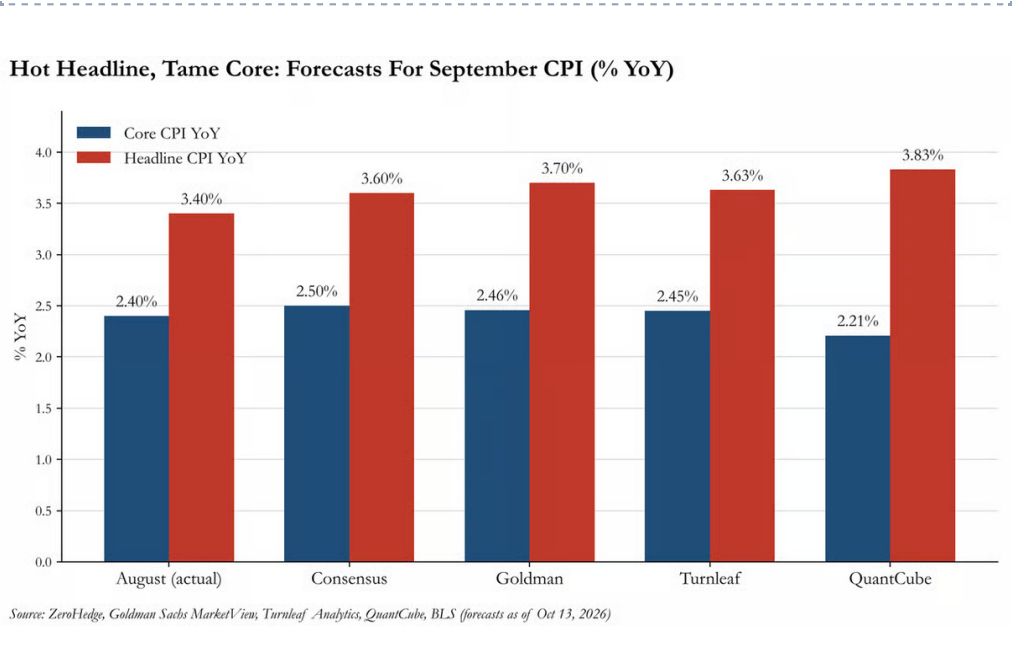
    高盛对核心 CPI 的预测高于市场共识：环比上涨 0.24%，而市场共识均值为 0.22%。



Economist	Firm	Estimate
Hugh A Johnson	Hugh Johnson Economics LLC	2.6%
Rogier Quaedvlieg	ABN Amro Bank NV	2.5%
James Egelhof	BNP Paribas	2.5%
	Bank of America Corp	2.5%
D. Porter/S. Anderson	Bank of Montreal	2.5%
Marc Giannoni	Barclays Capital Inc	2.5%
Uwe Duerkop	Berliner Sparkasse	2.5%
	Bloomberg Economics	2.5%
Avery Shenf	Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce	2.5%
[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]
Christopher Hodge	Natixis North America LLC	2.4%
Emman Siddiqi	Nippon Life Gbl Invtrs Americas Inc	2.4%
Yoshimasa Maruyama	SMBC Nikko Securities Inc	2.4%
Oscar Munoz	TD Securities USA LLC	2.4%
	UBS Securities LLC	2.4%
	Wells Fargo Bank NA	2.4%
Stephanie Roth	Wolfe Research LLC	2.4%
Samuel Tombs	Pantheon Macroeconomics Ltd	2.3%

Here is where several forecasters stand. One curiosity: QuantCube's nowcast has the *softest* core and the *hottest* headline of the bunch, a neat summary of an energy shock that (so far) refuses to bleed into everything else:

以下是几家预测机构的判断。有一点颇为耐人寻味：QuantCube 的即时预测显示，其核心通胀预测在各家中最低，而整体通胀预测最高，恰好概括了这场能源冲击的特点——迄今为止，它仍未蔓延至其他领域：



Source: ZeroHedge, Goldman Sachs MarketView, Turnleaf Analytics, QuantCube, BLS (forecasts as of Oct 13, 2026)

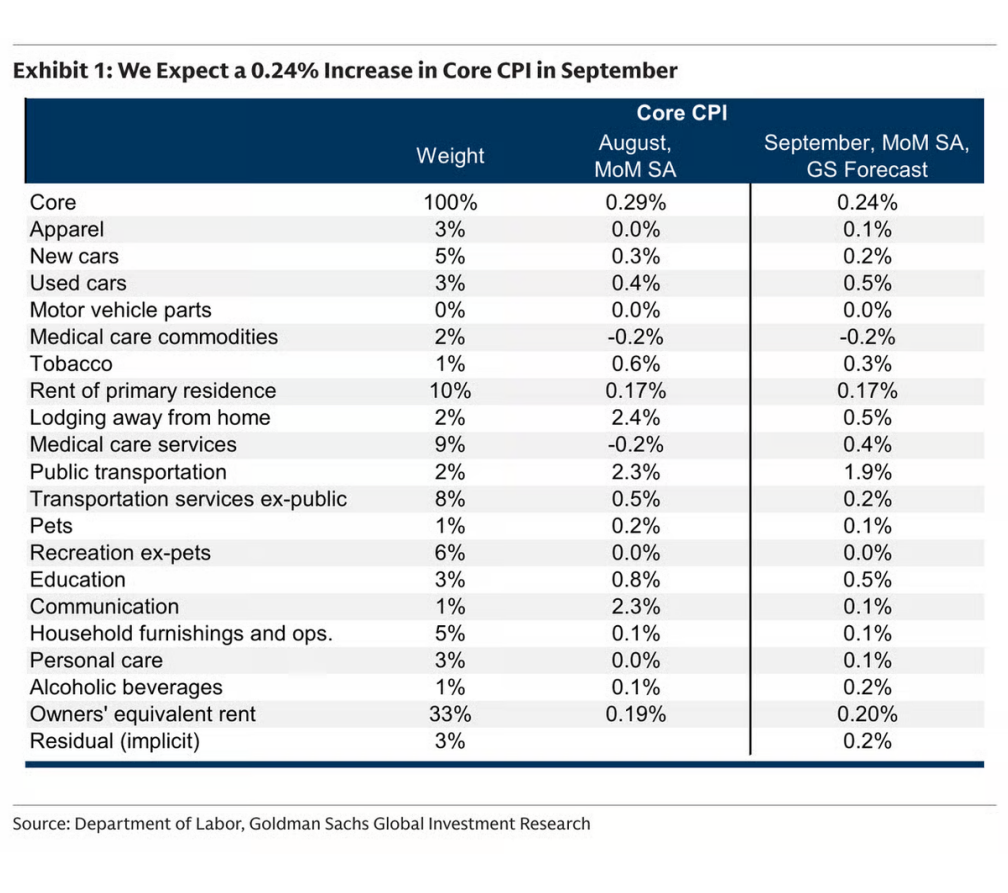
Autos Up, Shelter Down, Airfares Flying

汽车价格上涨，居住成本回落，机票价格飙升

In its September CPI preview (*available to pro subs*), Goldman's economists expect **a 0.24% increase in core CPI** (vs. +0.2% consensus), or 2.46% Y/Y (vs. 2.5% consensus), and a 0.59% rise in headline CPI (vs. +0.6% consensus), driven by higher food (+0.2%) and **energy (+5.0%)** prices on another jump in retail gasoline. That would put headline inflation at **3.70% Y/Y**, up from 3.40% in August and a tenth above consensus. Here is the bank's component-level breakdown:

在其 9 月 CPI 预览（专业订阅用户可查看）中，高盛经济学家预计，核心 CPI 将上涨 0.24%（市场一致预期为 +0.2%），同比上涨 2.46%（市场一致预期为 2.5%）；整体 CPI 将上涨 0.59%（市场一致预期为+0.6%）。推动因素是食品价格上涨（+0.2%）以及能源价格上涨（+5.0%），后者源于零售汽油价格再次大幅跳涨。这将使整体通胀率升至同比 3.70%，高于 8 月的 3.40%，并比市场一致预期高出 0.1 个百分点。以下是该行对各组成项目的细分预测：

Exhibit 1: We Expect a 0.24% Increase in Core CPI in September



		Core CPI	
	Weight	August, MoM SA	September, MoM SA, GS Forecast
Core	100%	0.29%	0.24%
Apparel	3%	0.0%	0.1%
New cars	5%	0.3%	0.2%
Used cars	3%	0.4%	0.5%
Motor vehicle parts	0%	0.0%	0.0%
Medical care commodities	2%	-0.2%	-0.2%
Tobacco	1%	0.6%	0.3%
Rent of primary residence	10%	0.17%	0.17%
Lodging away from home	2%	2.4%	0.5%
Medical care services	9%	-0.2%	0.4%
Public transportation	2%	2.3%	1.9%
Transportation services ex-public	8%	0.5%	0.2%
Pets	1%	0.2%	0.1%
Recreation ex-pets	6%	0.0%	0.0%
Education	3%	0.8%	0.5%
Communication	1%	2.3%	0.1%
Household furnishings and ops.	5%	0.1%	0.1%
Personal care	3%	0.0%	0.1%
Alcoholic beverages	1%	0.1%	0.2%
Owners' equivalent rent	33%	0.19%	0.20%
Residual (implicit)	3%		0.2%

Source: Department of Labor, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The bank highlights three key component-level trends:

该行重点指出了三个关键分项趋势：

1. **Autos.** A pickup in autos inflation, with used car prices up 0.5% (based on auction prices), new car prices up 0.2% (positive residual seasonality) and a 0.2% increase in auto insurance as Goldman's online dataset shows premiums creeping higher again after the spring price cuts.

   汽车。汽车通胀有所回升：二手车价格上涨 0.5%（依据拍卖价格），新车价格上涨 0.2%（受季节性因素残余影响而呈正向），汽车保险价格上涨 0.2%；高盛的线上数据集显示，春季降价后，保费再次缓慢走高。

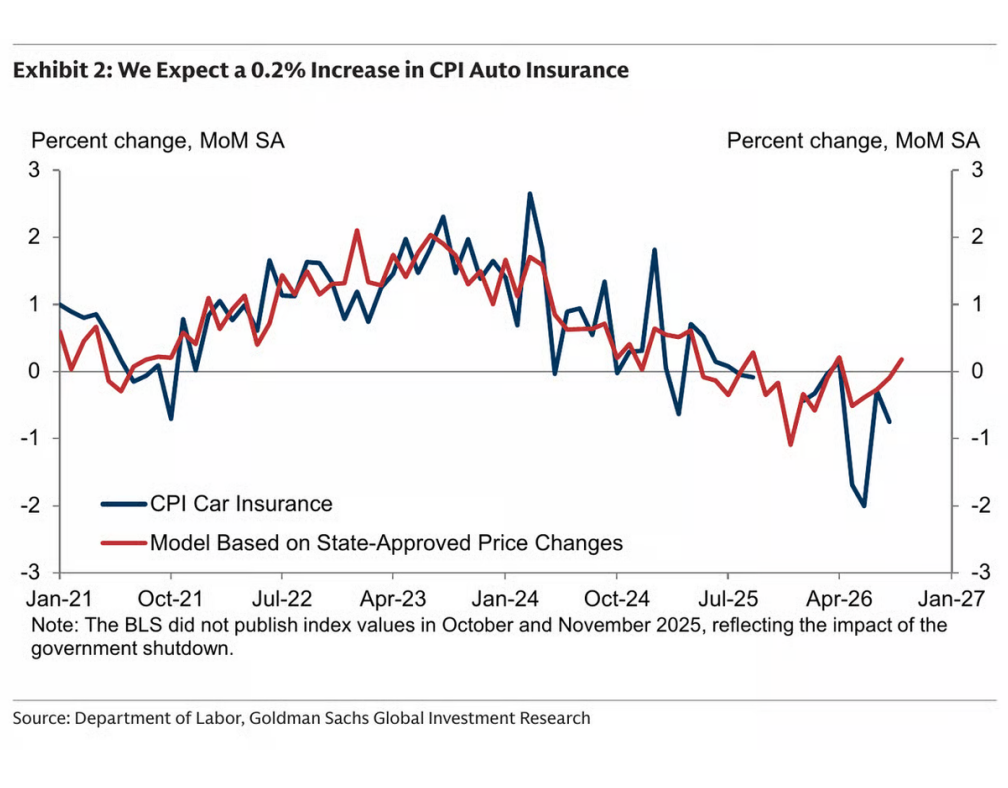
2. **Shelter.** Benign readings once again: OER +0.20% and rent +0.17%, reflecting the continued slowdown in their underlying trends. With OER a third of core, *this is the one thing keeping core in check*.

   住房。读数再度温和：业主等值租金（OER）上涨 0.20%，租金上涨 0.17%，反映出两者的潜在趋势持续放缓。OER 约占核心 CPI 的三分之一，这是目前抑制核心通胀的关键因素。

3. **Airfares.** A 3.0% jump in airfares, reflecting passthrough from the continued surge in jet fuel prices and the signal from Goldman's equity analysts' tracking of online fares.

   机票价格。机票价格上涨 3.0%，反映出航空燃油价格持续飙升带来的成本传导，以及高盛股票分析师对线上票价的追踪所显示的信号。

Exhibit 2: We Expect a 0.2% Increase in CPI Auto Insurance



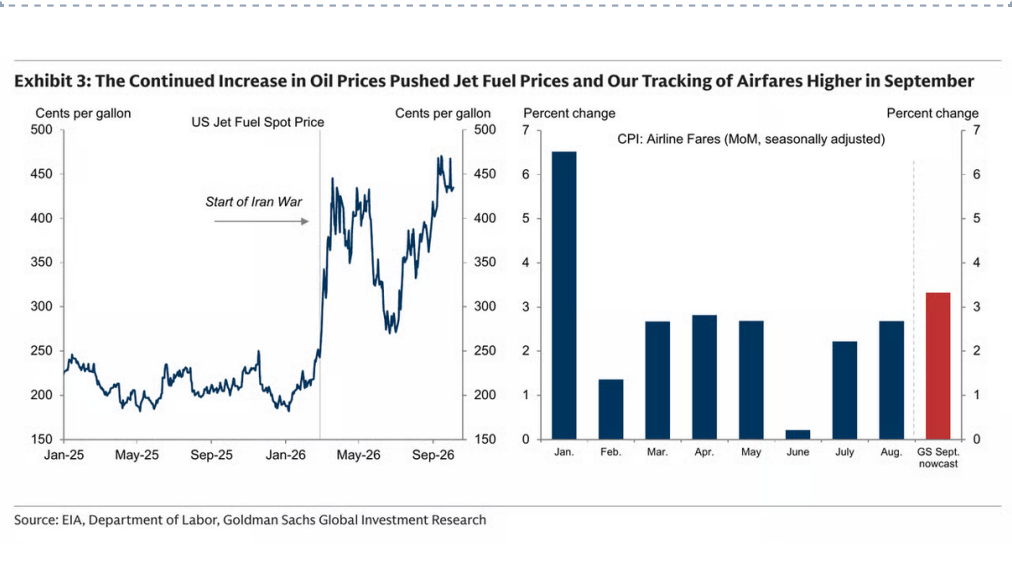
Note: The BLS did not publish index values in October and November 2025, reflecting the impact of the government shutdown.

Source: Department of Labor, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The airfare chart is the one to watch: jet fuel spot prices have roughly doubled since the start of the Iran war, and **airlines have been passing on every cent of it**. Regular readers will recall that we have been tracking the diesel and jet fuel squeeze for months, and as Apollo warned last month, the diesel shock is a core inflation shock; airfares are where it shows up first.

机票价格图表最值得关注：伊朗战争爆发以来，航空燃油现货价格大致翻了一番，航空公司已将每一分钱的涨幅都转嫁给消费者。常读者会记得，我们数月来一直在追踪柴油和航空燃油供应紧张的影响；正如阿波罗上月警告的那样，柴油冲击就是核心通胀冲击，而机票价格是这种冲击最先显现的领域。

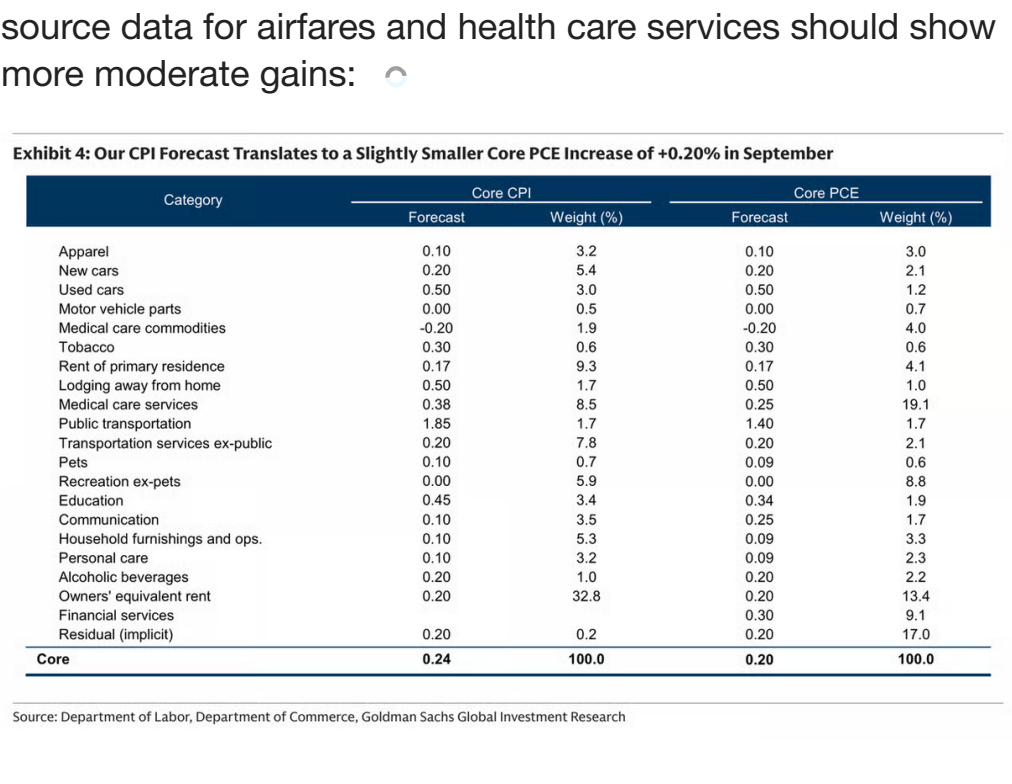
Exhibit 3: The Continued Increase in Oil Prices Pushed Jet Fuel Prices and Our Tracking of Airfares Higher in September



Source: EIA, Department of Labor, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

As for the Fed's preferred gauge, Goldman's CPI forecast translates into **a slightly smaller 0.20% increase in September core PCE** (due Oct 29), partly because new and used cars carry a lower weight in PCE and because PCE source data for airfares and health care services should show more moderate gains:

Exhibit 4: Our CPI Forecast Translates to a Slightly Smaller Core PCE Increase of +0.20% in September

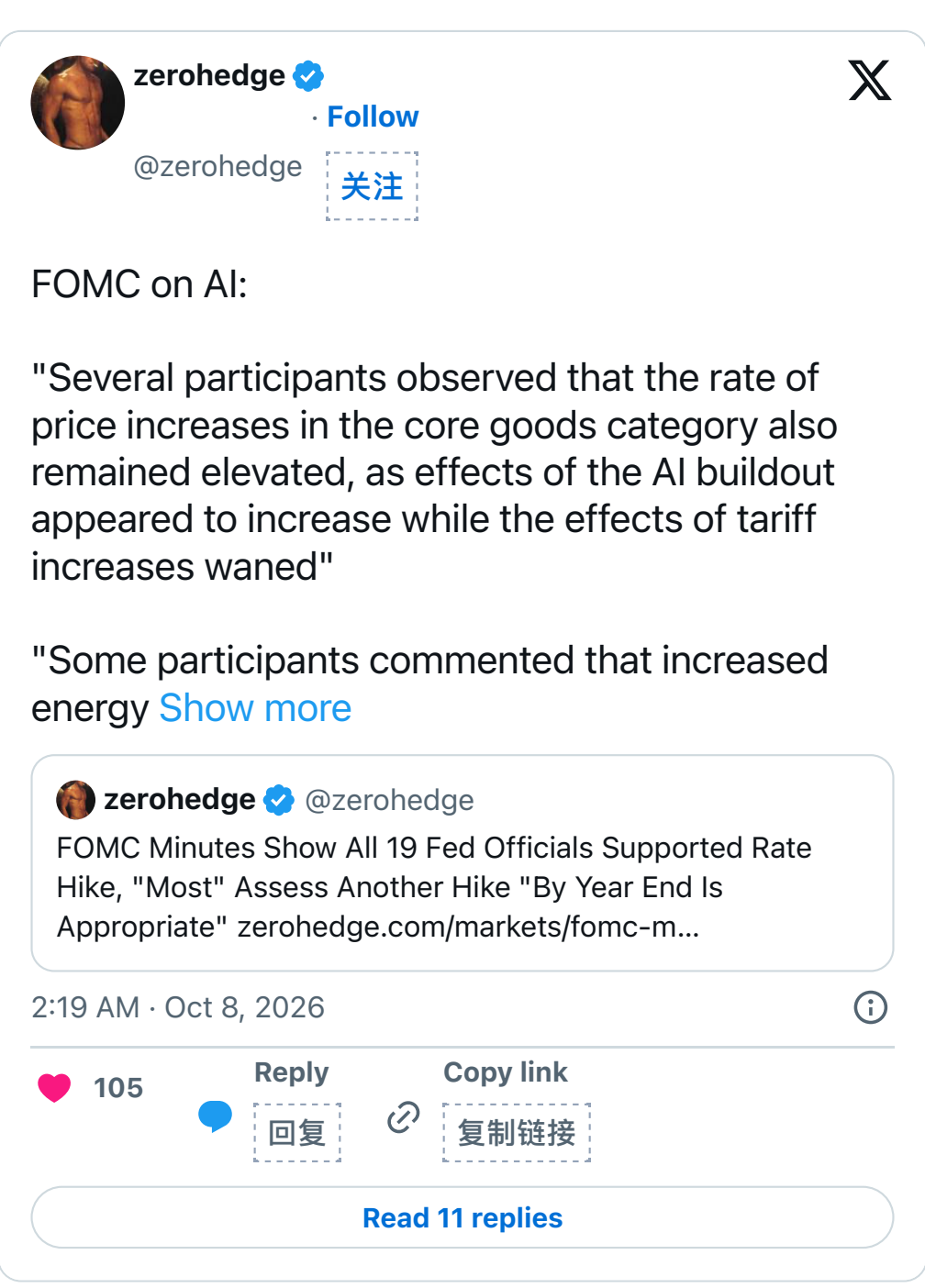


Category	Core CPI		Core PCE	
	Forecast	Weight (%)	Forecast	Weight (%)
Apparel	0.10	3.2	0.10	3.0
New cars	0.20	5.4	0.20	2.1
Used cars	0.50	3.0	0.50	1.2
Motor vehicle parts	0.00	0.5	0.00	0.7
Medical care commodities	-0.20	1.9	-0.20	4.0
Tobacco	0.30	0.6	0.30	0.6
Rent of primary residence	0.17	9.3	0.17	4.1
Lodging away from home	0.50	1.7	0.50	1.0
Medical care services	0.38	8.5	0.25	19.1
Public transportation	1.85	1.7	1.40	1.7
Transportation services ex-public	0.20	7.8	0.20	2.1
Pets	0.10	0.7	0.09	0.6
Recreation ex-pets	0.00	5.9	0.00	8.8
Education	0.45	3.4	0.34	1.9
Communication	0.10	3.5	0.25	1.7
Household furnishings and ops.	0.10	5.3	0.09	3.3
Personal care	0.10	3.2	0.09	2.3
Alcoholic beverages	0.20	1.0	0.20	2.2
Owners' equivalent rent	0.20	32.8	0.20	13.4
Financial services			0.30	9.1
Residual (implicit)	0.20	0.2	0.20	17.0
Core	**0.24**	**100.0**	**0.20**	**100.0**

Source: Department of Labor, Department of Commerce, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Looking beyond September, Goldman expects core CPI of around 0.2% in October, inflated by seasonal-factor distortions from the data the BLS never collected during last year's government shutdown (the gift that keeps on giving), and then **around 0.1% in November and December** as shelter keeps slowing and tariff effects fade. That projected slowdown is why Goldman's economists are more dovish than consensus heading into 2027. The bank's own caveat: **risks are tilted to the upside if the oil disruption proves more persistent than expected**. With Brent still above $105 and the Russia/Ukraine "energy ceasefire," in the words of Goldman's Rich Privorotsky, unable to "survive a news cycle," we would not bet on the downside.

And then there is AI. As we discussed on Monday, Goldman has admitted that AI blew up its inflation forecast, and the Fed is clearly paying attention. From last week's minutes:



FOMC on AI:

"Several participants observed that the rate of price increases in the core goods category also remained elevated, as effects of the AI buildout appeared to increase while the effects of tariff increases waned"

"Some participants commented that increased energy Show more

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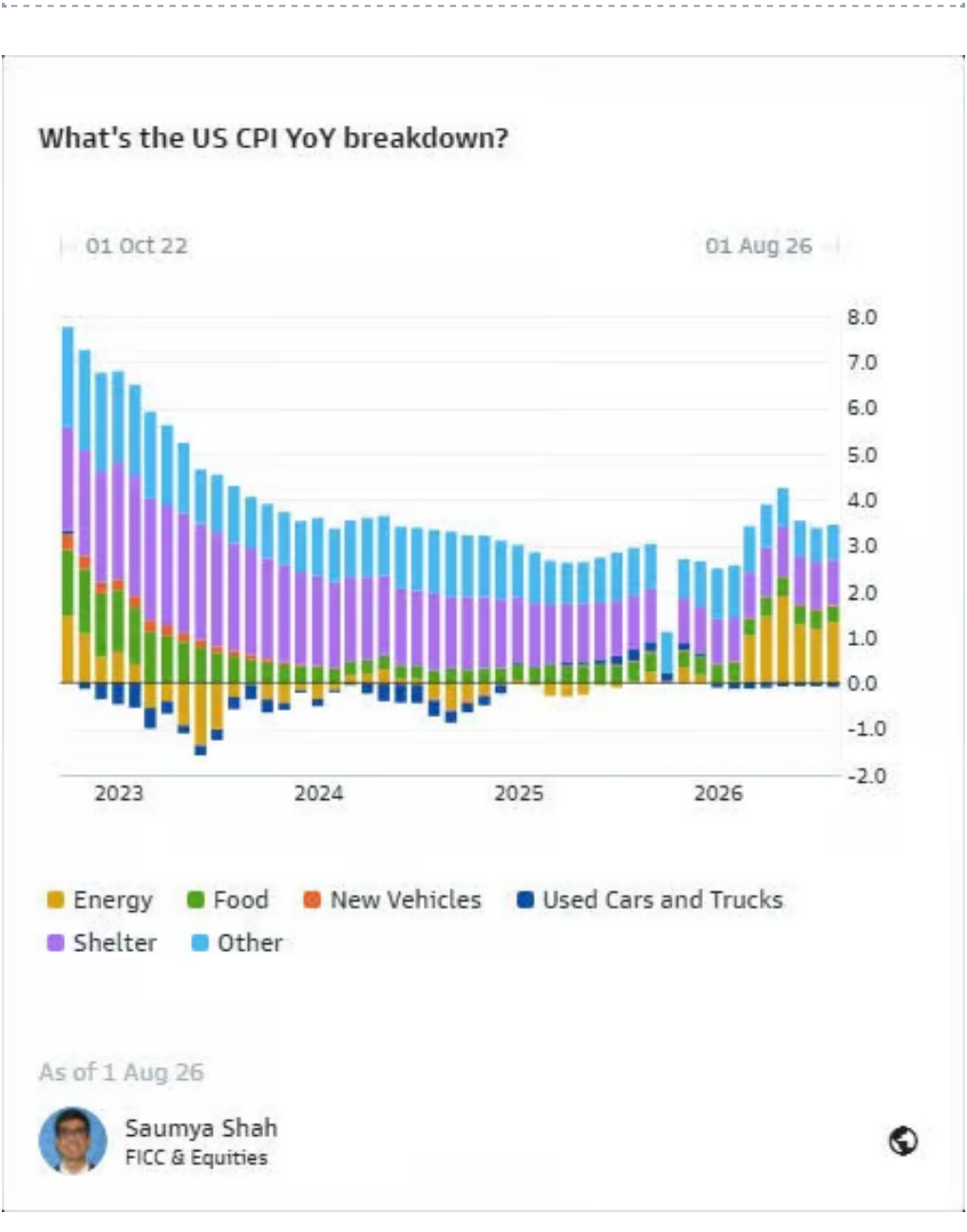
FOMC Minutes Show All 19 Fed Officials Supported Rate Hike, "Most" Assess Another Hike "By Year End Is Appropriate" zerohedge.com/markets/fomc-m...

2:19 AM · Oct 8, 2026

Meanwhile, households aren't waiting for the BLS: in the latest UMich survey, one-year inflation expectations rose to 4.7%, with 5-10 year expectations at 3.5%. Here is how the headline mix has evolved; note how much of the recent lift is energy (*chart source GS FICC MarketView*):

与此同时，家庭并没有等美国劳工统计局（BLS）公布数据：在密歇根大学（UMich）最新调查中，一年期通胀预期升至 4.7%，5 至 10 年期通胀预期为 3.5%。以下是总体指标构成的变化；请注意近期涨幅中有多少来自能源（图表来源：高盛 FICC MarketView）：



Fed Implications: A Hike Is Coming... Just Not Yet

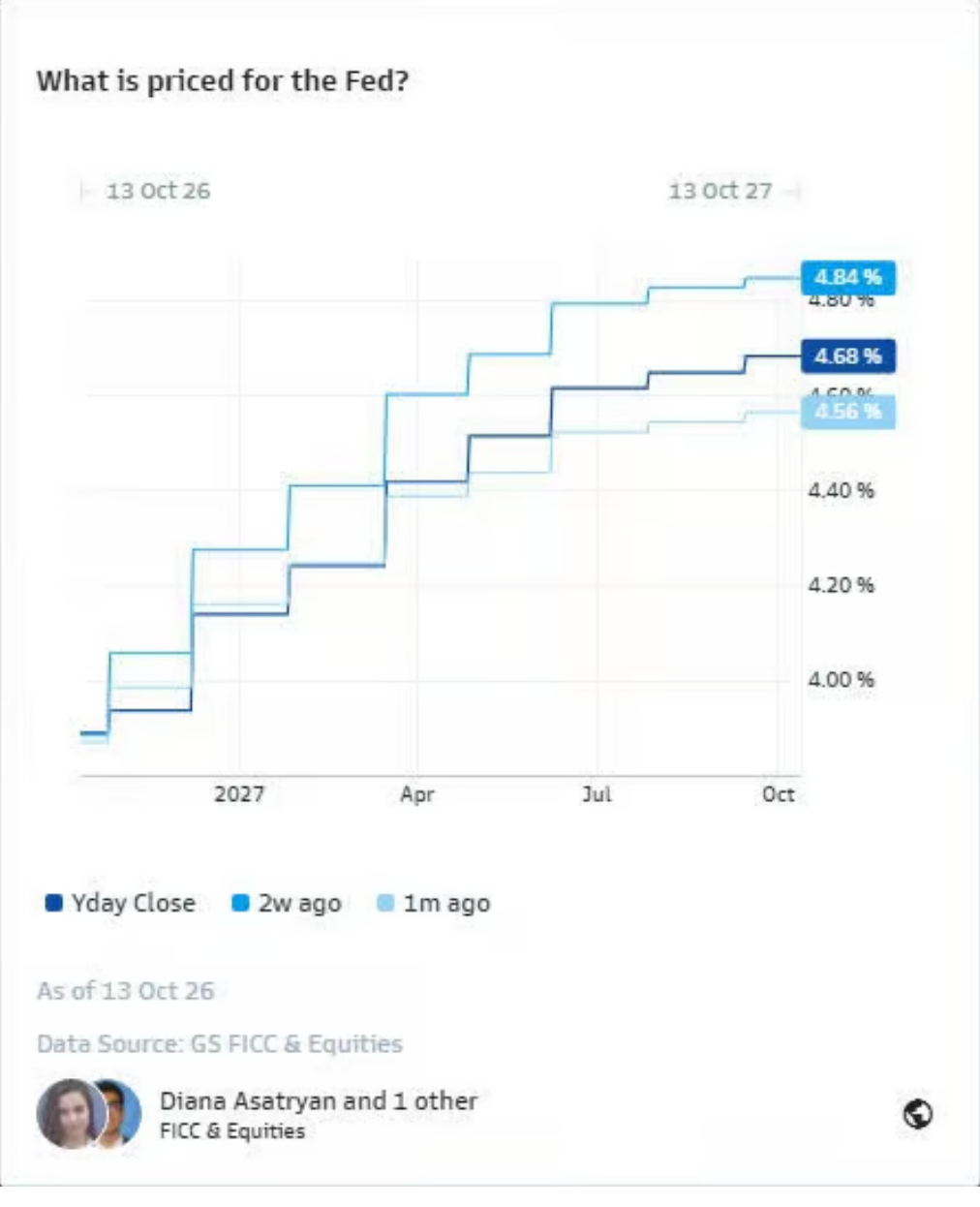
对美联储的影响：加息即将到来……但还不是现在

Given the Fed's emphasis on incoming data, the September report could meaningfully shift pricing for both the October and December meetings. A benign core print would cement the "patient" camp's case for waiting until December (or, if Goldman's 0.1% prints for November and December pan out, for not hiking again at all). A hot, broad-based core print would revive talk of an October move, though with a **hike just one week before the midterms**, history isn't on the hawks' side: as UBS pointed out, the Fed has never hiked in October ahead of US elections.

鉴于美联储强调将依据最新数据决策，9 月报告可能显著改变市场对 10 月和 12 月议息会议的定价。若核心通胀数据温和，将进一步巩固“耐心派”主张等到 12 月再行动的立场（或者，若高盛预测的 11 月和 12 月通胀率均为 0.1%得以实现，则可能根本无需再次加息）。若核心通胀数据高于预期且涨势广泛，市场关于 10 月加息的讨论将再度升温。不过，若在中期选举前一周加息，历史先例并不支持鹰派：正如瑞银指出，美联储从未在美国大选前的 10 月加息。

Here is what the market currently prices for the path of policy (*chart source GS FICC MarketView*):

以下为市场当前对政策路径的定价（图表来源：高盛 FICC MarketView）：



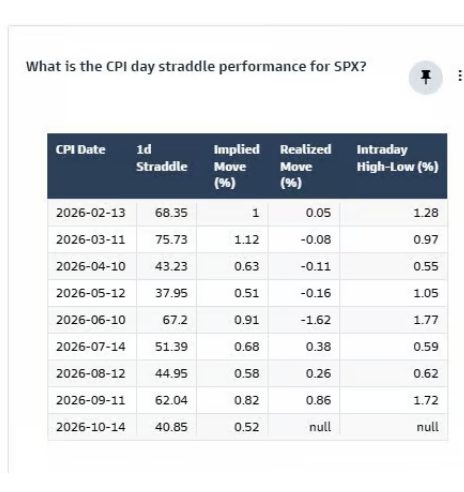
Not everyone is cheering the patience.

BofA's Michael Hartnett argued over the weekend that **"The Most Bullish Thing The Fed Can Do Now Is Hike"**, and with the long end still pricing a hefty term premium (more on that below), the bond market seems to agree that a Fed which sounds patient on inflation is a Fed it has to be paid extra to trust.

Market Reaction: Cheapest CPI Straddle Of The Year

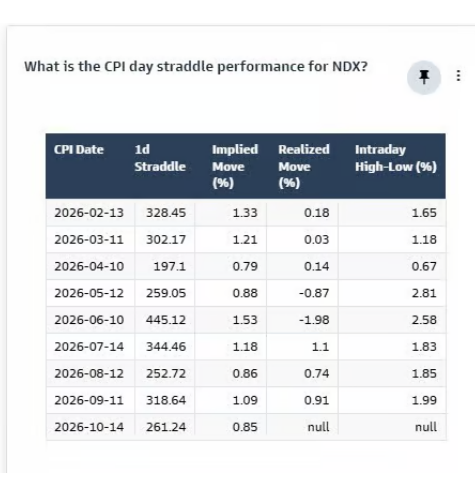
Since this month there is no JPMorgan market sensitivity scenario analysis, the usual "SPX up X% if core prints below Y%" table is MIA. We'll make do with what the options market says, and **it says nobody cares**.

Goldman's equity vol desk notes that the SPX straddle for Wednesday goes out at just **52bps ($41)**, *one of the lowest CPI straddles this year* and well below the 78bp average of recent events; the NDX straddle is ~85bps ($261) vs a 111bp average. And while flows were quiet on Tuesday, the desk did see a sizable buyer of SPX late-October put spreads (~$4.1mm vega in 10-delta puts), with skew steepening on persistent demand for year-end downside. Here is the CPI-day track record for SPX and NDX straddles in 2026 (*chart source GS FICC MarketView*):



What is the CPI day straddle performance for SPX?

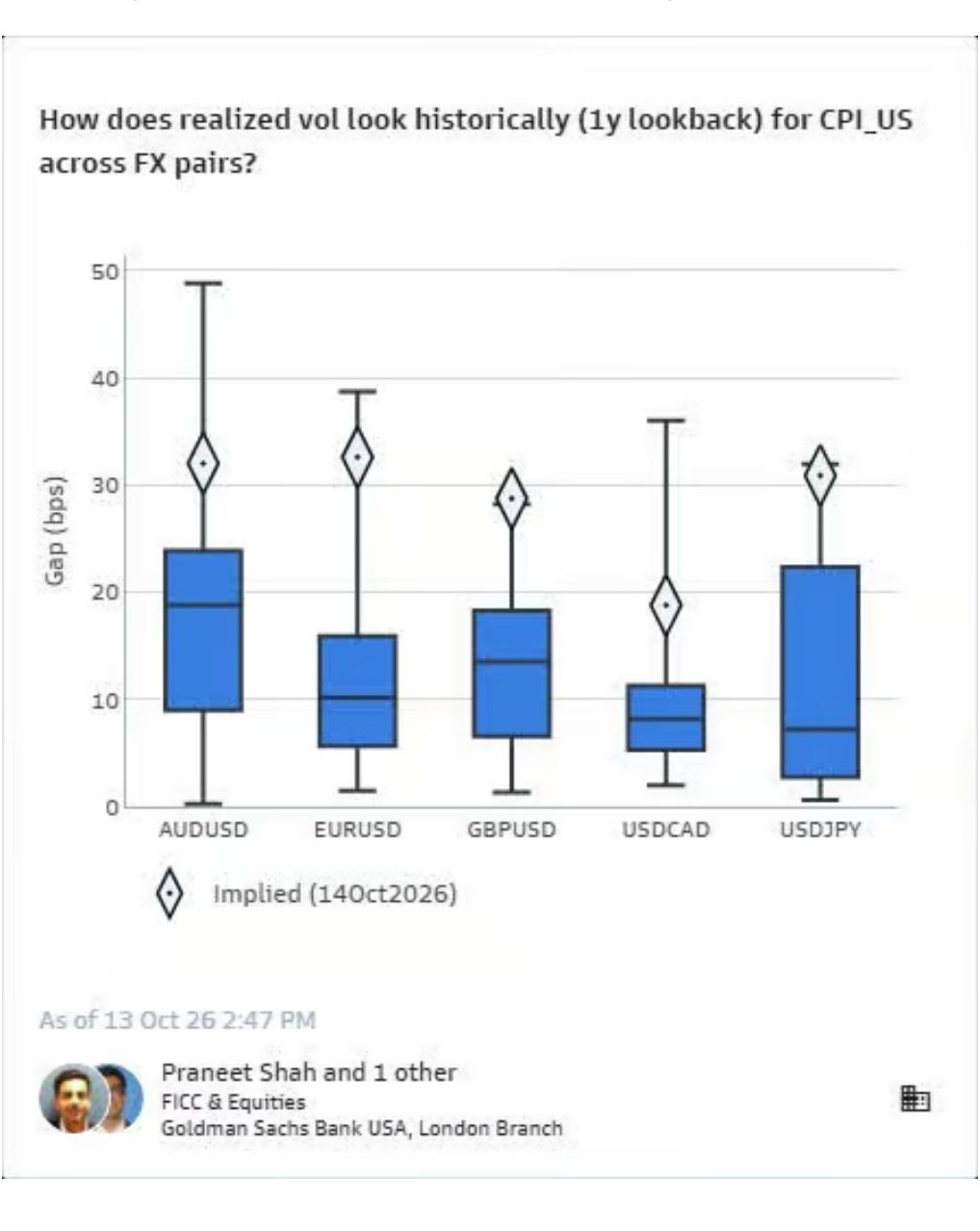
CPI Date	1d Straddle	Implied Move (%)	Realized Move (%)	Intraday High-Low (%)
2026-02-13	68.35	1	0.05	1.28
2026-03-11	75.73	1.12	-0.08	0.97
2026-04-10	43.23	0.63	-0.11	0.55
2026-05-12	37.95	0.51	-0.16	1.05
2026-06-10	67.2	0.91	-1.62	1.77
2026-07-14	51.39	0.68	0.38	0.59
2026-08-12	44.95	0.58	0.26	0.62
2026-09-11	62.04	0.82	0.86	1.72
2026-10-14	40.85	0.52	null	null



What is the CPI day straddle performance for NDX?

CPI Date	1d Straddle	Implied Move (%)	Realized Move (%)	Intraday High-Low (%)
2026-02-13	328.45	1.33	0.18	1.65
2026-03-11	302.17	1.21	0.03	1.18
2026-04-10	197.1	0.79	0.14	0.67
2026-05-12	259.05	0.88	-0.87	2.81
2026-06-10	445.12	1.53	-1.98	2.58
2026-07-14	344.46	1.18	1.1	1.83
2026-08-12	252.72	0.86	0.74	1.85
2026-09-11	318.64	1.09	0.91	1.99
2026-10-14	261.24	0.85	null	null

FX is a different story. Goldman's MarketView team notes EURUSD is pricing its **richest CPI event gap in a year at ~32bps** (77th percentile of the 1-year distribution), with implied moves across the major pairs at 20-32bps, all above the historical upper quartile. The gap is particularly striking for USDJPY, where implied vol is more than 4x its historical median (*chart source GS FICC MarketView*):



Put differently, equities are priced for a non-event, FX is priced for fireworks, and rates are somewhere in between. One of them is wrong.

Thoughts From Around The Goldman Trading Desk

One-liner: Goldman's economists are on the firm side of consensus, but **the desk sees the asymmetry on the downside**: a soft print would do far more damage to the hawks than a firm one would do to the doves.

- **Rates.** In the bank's "What Matters Today" note, the desk flags that **a 10bp downside surprise on core would be meaningful for rates**. The MBS desk (Mark Flood) is less sanguine on the other side, warning that given Goldman's 0.24% call, "*a marginal beat could prove problematic for rates.*" According to the Short Macro desk, real money has been a better buyer of the front end while hedge funds have been fading any rally that takes December pricing under 25bp; overall, **the street feels light on risk into the print**. FICC EMEA rates sales likes receiving the October FOMC on any selloff, viewing any CPI-driven revival of hike bets as an opportunity to add October receivers.
- **Swaps.** The GS Swaps Trading desk (Ilir Xholi) went a step further on Tuesday, recommending **receiving the 10y10y swap at 5.26%** (target 4.99%, stop 5.40%) on the view that the long-end term premium has run ahead of fundamentals. Between Sep 22 and Oct 7, 10y10y rose 47bp while the 2Y swap didn't move at all, which the desk reads as pure term premium rather than Fed path. The first catalyst on its list is Wednesday's CPI: after the soft August core PCE, "*a second soft inflation print would challenge the inflation-risk premium built into the long end.*" Other catalysts include the Treasury's dealer questionnaire this Friday ahead of a refunding where the market may start to price smaller long-end auctions, something Citi just told us to expect. The risks: a hot CPI, or the energy war escalating again.
- **FX Strategy.** Mike Cahill (Head of FX Strategy) cautions that with Goldman on the firm side for this print, **anyone hoping for a dovish shift in Fed pricing and a weaker dollar won't get the trigger from CPI** in the next few months, based on the bank's forecasts. That said, he still sees good value in hedging for a bigger USD move given still-low implied vol.
- **FX Options.** Theo Alexis (FX Options Trading) notes that after the rates selloff, the dollar's gains and the build-up of short EURUSD positioning, **the volatile side of the distribution is a downside CPI surprise**. Event gaps are similar across EUR, GBP, AUD and JPY at 30-32bp.
- **Oil.** Rich Privorotsky, Goldman's Head of Delta One Trading, was characteristically blunt about the latest attempt to talk energy prices down: the market is distinguishing between geopolitical escalation and barrels actually lost, which he calls "*a fragile equilibrium,*" and so far everything short of a deal on Hormuz has been tried without much success. Translation: the energy component that drives Goldman's 5% jump in CPI energy isn't going anywhere fast.

The full desk commentary is available to pro subs.

Bottom Line

The consensus setup is a hot headline driven by gasoline and a tame core held in check by shelter, which is exactly the mix that lets the Fed say it is "patient" while still promising a hike by December. Goldman's economists expect core to slide toward 0.1% by year-end and have become more dovish than consensus for 2027, while the bank's desks see more pain from a downside miss than an upside beat.

We are less convinced the Fed gets off that easy. Energy is now **the** inflation story: jet fuel, diesel and gasoline are all flowing into CPI, the FOMC is openly flagging AI-driven core goods inflation, and household inflation expectations are at multi-year highs. A 0.2% core print buys the Fed a quiet October, and not much more: the winter heating bill is still in the mail. *With SPX straddles at their cheapest of the year, the market is priced for the former and not at all for the latter.*

我们不太相信美联储能如此轻松地过关。能源如今已成为通胀主线：航空燃油、柴油和汽油价格都在传导至 CPI；FOMC 公开指出，AI 正推动核心商品通胀；家庭通胀预期也升至多年高位。核心 CPI 环比上涨 0.2%，足以让美联储在 10 月暂得清静，但也仅此而已：冬季取暖账单还在路上。SPX 跨式期权组合价格处于年内最低水平，市场定价反映了前一种情形，却完全没有计入后一种情形。

Much more in the full Goldman "US Daily: September CPI Preview" and the GS Swaps desk's "Receive 10y10y rate: the term-premium leg has run ahead of fundamentals" note, both available to pro subs.